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assent after which the Government issues a notification in the official gazette to make them operational. Due to administrative reasons, Parliament delegates the power of commencement of the Act to the executive as it may require the setting up of a regulator or even infrastructure like special courts. Many believe that by not issuing such a notification within a reasonable period of time, or withholding parts of it, the executive has assumed law-making functions, with the power to veto certain parts of the law which it is not in agreement with. "If the Government is not notifying the acts passed by the Parliament in its entirety, it is a subversion of the sanctity of Parliament. It reflects the Government's utter contempt for the will of the people," says CP(M) Politburo and Rajya Sabha member Brinda Karat. Though the notification process is usually left to the executive, Rajya Sabha Deputy Chairman Rahman Khan feels that the members should seek clarification in the House from the respective ministries for failing to fully notify Acts passed by the Parliament. "Even various parliamentary committees can suo moto seek clarifications from the executive for failing to bring in an Act passed by Parliament," he adds.

When Parliament passed the Petroleum and Natural Gas Regulatory Board (PNGRB) Act 2006, it was aimed at providing for a regulator; a focused agency that would enable distribution of natural gas, critical for economic growth, without corporate capture. But when the Government quietly set aside Section 16 of the Act, which explicitly said that no entity shall lay, build, operate or expand any pipeline without the authorisation of the board, the prospects for new CNG projects dwindled away. By setting aside this clause, the prospect of laying piped natural gas connections across urban homes has become bleak and millions of domestic gas consumers are left with no option but to queue up for untrustworthy and poorly managed gas cylinder supplies. In the last week of January, the Delhi High